

Art & Design

Year 5 · Student Manual
The Craft Studio

A Cambridge Pathway student book for Upper Primary. Written for pupils of about nine to ten years old who are ready to draw with more control, sculpt in three dimensions, craft with fabric, and paint with purpose and feeling.

Four tables in one craft studio: drawing, sculpture, fabric and paint. Rufus the fox and Bruno the bear work beside you.

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Interior 8.5 × 11 in (Amazon KDP). British English throughout.

This book is meant to be used. Draw in it. Build in it. Stitch and paint in it.

Safety: washable media, blunt tools, needles only with adult supervision, clay work with clean hands and tools. Teachers follow school policy.

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Welcome to the Craft Studio

There is a long wooden table, a jar of brushes, a lump of clay and a folded square of fabric.

This book is that room. It is called **the Craft Studio**, and it belongs to you for Year 5.

In earlier years you looked carefully, printed, painted, drew depth and built simple structures. Keep that. This year your hands learn four deeper crafts: **drawing processes**, **sculpting**, **fabric and craft**, and **painting for purpose and expression**.

🕒 DO YOU REMEMBER?

Year 4 asked for purpose and perspective. Year 5 asks for control and choice: which tool, which material, which feeling, and why.

Who you will meet



Rufus the fox

He draws lines until they mean something.
He measures proportions before he sculpts.
He plans a craft before the first stitch.



Bruno the bear

He mixes colour for mood as well as for matching. He presses clay slowly. He is good at saying what a piece is for and how it feels.



The craft table

Drawing tools, clay, fabric scraps, paints and sketchbooks live here. Clean as you go. Finished work dries on the side shelf.

You

Age about nine or ten. Ready to choose materials, finish projects, and talk about process as well as product.

How to use this book

✦ SIGNS TO LOOK FOR

- **Open the door** - talk before you begin
- **Warm up your hands** - a quick skill game
- **Your turn** - make, draw, build or stitch
- **Did you know?** - a true fact
- **Go a bit further** - extra challenge
- **Big challenge** - longer task
- **How did it go?** - short review

Dashed boxes are yours. There are no printed right answers for open making.



Picture 0.1 Studio signs return on every page so you know what to do next.

Getting set up

Your studio kit

- pencils (H, HB, 2B), charcoal, ink pen (adult choice), rubber, sharpener
- sketchbook or spare drawing paper
- air-dry clay or modelling clay, board, blunt tools
- fabric scraps, felt, yarn, blunt needles, glue, scissors (safety)
- washable paints, flat and round brushes, palette, water pot
- apron or old shirt

Room norms

- 1 Look before you touch.
- 2 Share tools; return them.
- 3 Keep water, paint and clay contained.
- 4 Needles and cutting tools only with adult rules.
- 5 Talk kindly about work: process and purpose.

✦ WARM UP YOUR HANDS

Shake hands for five seconds. Press palms together, then open wide like stars. Three times. Ready.



Picture 0.2 Craft kit on the table: drawing tools, clay, fabric scraps, paints and brushes.

UNIT 1 · DRAWING TABLE

1

Exploring drawing processes

Line, tools, looking hard, and a project that is yours.

A drawing process is the way you build a drawing: marks first, tools next, observation, then a finished personal piece.

© IN THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- ✓ explore mark making and line on purpose
- ✓ try different drawing tools and compare them
- ✓ strengthen observational drawing
- ✓ complete a personal drawing project

◆ ON THE TABLE TODAY

Rufus lays out an H pencil, a soft 2B, a charcoal stick and a pen.

"Same leaf," he says. "Four tools. Four different conversations with the paper."

Bruno grins. "I will start messy and finish careful. That is also a process."



Picture 1.0 Drawing table with pencils, charcoal, pen and a single leaf ready to study.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.1

Understanding mark making and line

■ Open the door

Can a line feel calm? Can a line feel angry? How?

► **Here is how it works**

Mark making is every trace your tool leaves: dots, dashes, hatches, smudges, continuous lines.

LINE IDEA	WHAT IT CAN SUGGEST
thin continuous	careful outline, wire, hair
thick bold	weight, shadow edge, energy
broken / dashed	movement, soft edge
hatched	tone and form without outline

• **YOUR TURN**

Fill four boxes with different mark families. Label them in your own words.

MARKS 1

MARKS 2

MARKS 3

MARKS 4



Picture 1.1 Four mark-making samples on one sheet: thin line, bold line, hatch and smudge.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.2

Experimenting with different drawing tools

Open the door

Which tool is bravest for a dark shadow: an H pencil or charcoal?

► Here is how it works

TOOL	STRENGTH	WATCH OUT
H pencil	light construction	can dig into paper
HB / 2B	everyday drawing	needs sharpening
charcoal	rich darks, soft edges	smudges easily
ink pen	final confident line	hard to erase

• YOUR TURN

Draw the same simple object three times, each with a different tool.

My favourite tool for darks: _____



Picture 1.2 One cup drawn three ways: graphite, charcoal and ink.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.3

Developing observational drawing skills

■ Open the door

What changes when you look for ten seconds before the pencil moves?

► **Here is how it works**

Observational drawing means the real thing stays in front of you.

Loop: look → draw a little → look again → correct.

Big shapes first. Edges second. Small details last. Measure with your pencil held at arm's length if it helps.

▲ **BIG CHALLENGE**

Draw a still-life setup of three objects for 25 focused minutes. No inventing from memory.

● **YOUR TURN**

OBSERVATION DRAWING

One thing I corrected after looking again:



Picture 1.3 Still life of three objects with a careful observational drawing beside them.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.4

Creating a personal drawing project

■ Open the door

What subject matters enough to you that you will finish it carefully?

► Here is how it works

A **personal project** needs:

- 1 a chosen subject and reason
- 2 tool choices written down
- 3 sketches before the final
- 4 a finished drawing with a short label

• YOUR TURN

Subject:

Why it matters to me:

Tools I will use: _____

THUMBNAIL PLANS

FINAL DRAWING SPACE

© HOW DID IT GO?

- ☐ I can name different kinds of marks and lines.
- ☐ I compared at least three drawing tools.
- ☐ I drew from observation.
- ☐ I finished a personal drawing project.

My best process choice was:

UNIT 2 · SCULPT TABLE

2

Sculpting

Form, proportion, materials, and clay that stands.

Sculpture is art in three dimensions. You build height, width and depth that you can walk around with your eyes.

© IN THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- ✓ study forms and proportions
- ✓ try materials and joining techniques
- ✓ construct a 3D sculpture that stands
- ✓ make a clay work with care

◆ ON THE TABLE TODAY

Bruno rolls a clay sphere. "If the head is too big for the body," he says, "the figure tips."

Rufus builds a cardboard armature. "Strong inside first," he says. "Pretty surface second."



Picture 2.0 Sculpt table with clay, card tubes and a simple standing figure in progress.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.1

Studying forms and proportions

■ Open the door

Is a head usually as tall as a whole body, or closer to one seventh of the height?

► Here is how it works

Basic **forms**: sphere, cylinder, cube, cone, pyramid.

Proportion is how parts relate in size. For a simple figure: head smaller than body, feet wide enough to stand.

• **YOUR TURN**

Build three basic forms from clay or card. Sketch them too.

SPHERE

CYLINDER

CUBE



Picture 2.1 Clay sphere, cylinder and cube on a board with soft daylight.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.2

Experimenting with materials and techniques

■ Open the door

When would card be better than clay? When would clay win?

► Here is how it works

MATERIAL	GOOD FOR	JOIN IDEA
clay	organic forms	score and slip / press join
card	planes and architecture-like forms	slot, tape, glue tab
wire / pipe cleaner	line in space	twist
found clean objects	mixed sculpture	glue with adult help

• YOUR TURN

Join two different materials into one small study piece.

Materials:

Join method: _____



Picture 2.2 Card and clay joined in a small mixed study sculpture.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.3

Constructing a 3D sculpture

■ Open the door

Does your sculpture tell a viewer which way is the front?

► Here is how it works

Build order:

- 1 purpose or idea in one sentence
- 2 armature or base
- 3 main volumes
- 4 details last
- 5 test: does it stand when the table is tapped gently?

▲ BIG CHALLENGE

Build a standing sculpture at least as tall as your hand. Label it.

● YOUR TURN

Purpose:

PLAN / PHOTO OF SCULPTURE



Picture 2.3 A finished standing card-and-clay sculpture on a wide base.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.4

Clay works

■ Open the door

What happens if you add wet clay to bone-dry clay without a strong join?

► Here is how it works

Clay habits for school:

- 1 wedge or knead gently to remove big air pockets
- 2 keep a damp cloth over spare clay
- 3 score and wet joins
- 4 hollow thick forms so they dry without cracking
- 5 dry slowly; paint only when the teacher says it is ready

• YOUR TURN

Make a small clay pot or animal form with a strong join.

CLAY WORK

© HOW DID IT GO?

- ☐ I can name basic 3D forms.

- ☐ I joined materials on purpose.
- ☐ I built a sculpture that stands.
- ☐ I used clay carefully.

The join I trust most is: _____

UNIT 3 · CRAFT TABLE

3

Fabric and craft

Texture, stitch, mixed media, decoration.

Fabric has grain, stretch and pattern. Craft joins soft and hard materials into something you can hold and use or display.

🕒 IN THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- ✓ explore fabric textures and patterns
- ✓ learn basic craft techniques safely
- ✓ make a mixed-media craft project
- ✓ try decorative techniques

◆ ON THE TABLE TODAY

Rufus sorts fabric squares: smooth cotton, rough burlap, soft felt.

"Same red," he says, "three different feelings under your fingers."

Bruno threads a blunt needle. "Slow stitches. No rushing the knot."



Picture 3.0 Craft table with fabric scraps, yarn, blunt needle and scissors.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.1

Exploring fabric textures and patterns

■ Open the door

Can you name a fabric by touch with your eyes closed?

► Here is how it works

Describe fabric with honest words: smooth, rough, soft, stiff, shiny, matte, stretchy, open weave.

Pattern can be printed, woven or stitched.

• **YOUR TURN**

Rubbings or sketches of three fabrics. Label the texture words.

FABRIC A

FABRIC B

FABRIC C



Picture 3.1 Three fabric samples with different weaves and patterns on a table.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.2

Learning basic craft techniques

■ Open the door

What is the difference between a running stitch and a glue join?

► Here is how it works

TECHNIQUE	USE	SAFETY
running stitch	join or decorate fabric	blunt needle; adult rules
overstitch / whip	stronger edge	same
glue tab	paper/fabric collage	thin glue, dry flat
weaving (card loom)	pattern strips	careful tension

● YOUR TURN

Practise a row of running stitches on scrap fabric or draw the stitch path if sewing is not available today.



Picture 3.2 A neat row of running stitches on felt with yarn.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.3

Creating a craft project with mixed media

■ Open the door

What job will your craft object do: gift, badge, wall piece, bookmark?

► Here is how it works

Mixed media means more than one material working together.

Plan: purpose → materials → order of work → finish.

▲ BIG CHALLENGE

Make a mixed-media craft object with at least two materials and one decorative detail.

• YOUR TURN

Purpose:

Materials:

PROJECT PLAN / PHOTO



Picture 3.3 A finished mixed-media craft badge combining fabric, card and stitch.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.4

Exploring decorative techniques

■ Open the door

When does decoration help a design, and when does it hide a weak structure?

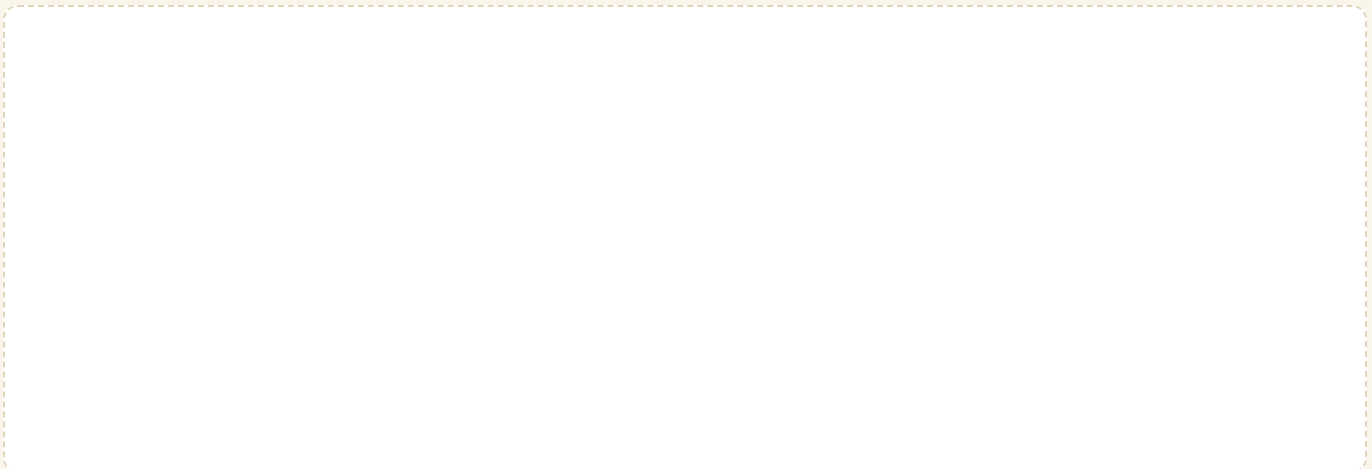
► Here is how it works

Decoration ideas: embroidery dots, fabric paint marks, appliqué shapes, bead with adult help, simple print on fabric.

Rule: structure first, decoration second.

● YOUR TURN

Decorate a sample square three ways. Circle the strongest.





Picture 3.4 Three decorative samples: stitch dots, painted marks and an appliqué shape.

© HOW DID IT GO?

- ☐ I can describe fabric textures.
- ☐ I practised a basic craft technique.
- ☐ I made a mixed-media piece with a purpose.
- ☐ I tried decorative techniques without hiding the structure.

My favourite fabric word today: _____

UNIT 4 • PAINT TABLE

4

Painting for purpose

Mix, texture, a job to do, and colour that feels.

Painting can explain, decorate, persuade or express a feeling. Purpose and expression work together when you choose colour and brushwork on purpose.

© IN THIS UNIT YOU WILL

- ✓ mix colour and control brush techniques
- ✓ build texture and surface effects
- ✓ develop a painting for a specific purpose
- ✓ explore how colour can influence emotions

◆ ON THE TABLE TODAY

Bruno mixes a calm blue-green. "This is for a quiet reading-corner poster," he says.

Rufus dabs a dry brush. "Texture first on the tree bark. Feeling second: strong and steady."



Picture 4.0 Paint table with palette, brushes and a board ready for a purposeful painting.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.1

Exploring colour mixing and brush techniques

■ Open the door

Can you mix a grey without a grey tube?

► Here is how it works

Primary mixes make secondary colours. Tint = lighter; shade = darker.

Brush bank: wash, dry brush, dab, thin line, scumble (as in earlier years, now used with more control).

• YOUR TURN

Mix a target colour from life (or from a paper swatch) and paint a brush test strip.

TARGET MIX

WASH

DRY BRUSH

DAB

LINE



Picture 4.1 Palette mixes beside a five-mark brush test strip.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.2

Experimenting with texture and effects

■ Open the door

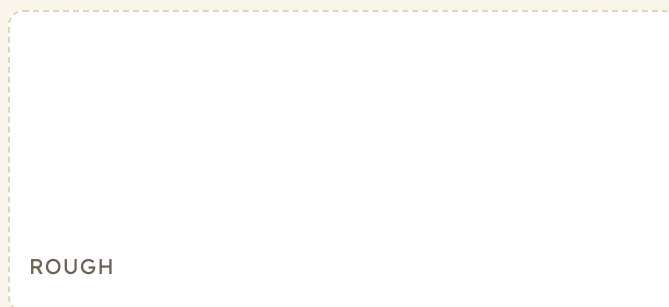
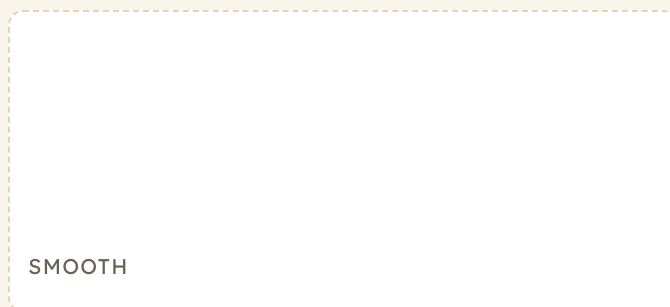
How can paint look rough without using sand?

► Here is how it works

Dry brush, sponge dab (adult choice), thick beside thin, scratched lines into damp paint (with safe tools).

● YOUR TURN

Make two panels: smooth surface and rough surface.



Picture 4.2 Smooth wash panel beside a rough dry-brush panel.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.3

Developing a painting for a specific purpose

■ Open the door

If you cannot say the job of the painting in one sentence, the design is not ready.

► Here is how it works

Purpose examples: class poster, thank-you card front, mural panel sketch, science fair display header.

Steps: write purpose → thumbnail → colour plan → paint → label.

▲ BIG CHALLENGE

Complete a painting that someone else can use (display or gift).
Include a purpose sentence on the label.

● YOUR TURN

Purpose:

THUMBNAIL

FINAL PAINTING SPACE



Picture 4.3 A clear purpose painting drying on an easel with a short label card.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.4

How colour can influence emotions

■ Open the door

Does warm orange feel the same as cool blue to you? Why might a poster choose one over the other?

► Here is how it works

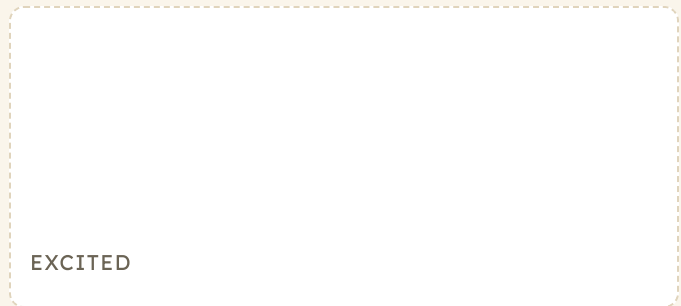
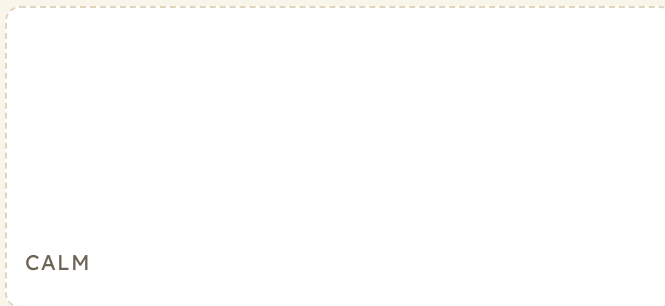
Colour does not force a feeling, but it can **suggest** mood: calm, energy, warning, celebration. Artists choose palettes to support purpose.

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

Many warning signs use high-contrast colour pairs so they read quickly from far away. Feeling and function meet in the design.

• YOUR TURN

Paint two small swatch scenes: **calm** and **excited**. Same subject if you can.



What I changed:



Picture 4.4 Two small landscape panels, one in cool calm colours and one in warm energetic colours.

Studio show

Choose your strongest drawing, sculpture or clay work, craft piece and purpose painting.

For each, say: purpose, main material or tool, one improvement for next time.

STUDIO SHOW PLAN

© HOW DID IT GO?

- ☐ I mixed colour and controlled brushes.
- ☐ I created texture on purpose.
- ☐ I painted for a clear purpose.
- ☐ I explored colour and mood.

My proudest piece this year:

Studio words

mark making · form · proportion · armature · mixed media · purpose · expression · texture · wash · running stitch · score and slip · observation · appliqué

Sources and references

Scheme in PDF/Input is scope only. Detail in 05-SOURCES-01.md.

For teachers

Mapping

Four units match the 2025–2026 / Y5 Art & Design scheme file.

Assessment (studio show)

UNIT	EVIDENCE
1	personal drawing project
2	standing sculpture + clay work
3	mixed-media craft with purpose
4	purpose painting + mood colour study

School activities

- Drawing walk: tools and outdoor observation
- Sculpture display corridor
- Fabric collage for a class banner
- Purpose painting for a real school display need

Safety

Needles, cutting tools and clay dust: school policy. Outdoor mural-style paint only with full plan.